

Welcome to Beacon

You just received your license key. This guide will have you logging sessions and tracking your SB 179 compliance in the next 10 minutes.

A few quick definitions

SB 179 — Texas Senate Bill 179, which requires elementary school counselors to spend at least 80% of their time on direct and indirect services to students (the “80/20 rule”).

MTSS — Multi-Tiered System of Supports. A framework for organizing student interventions into tiers (1 = universal, 2 = targeted, 3 = intensive).

Local Mode — Beacon’s default data mode. Your student data lives in your browser on your computer. It never leaves your machine unless you export it yourself.

Get started in 10 minutes

- 1 Open Beacon**
Go to <https://clearpath-beacon.pages.dev> in Chrome, Edge, or Safari. Bookmark it or install it as an app from your browser menu.
- 2 Choose Local Mode**
Local Mode is selected by default. Enter your name, your campus, your district, and your school year start and end dates.
- 3 Activate your license**
Paste your license key in the format **BCN - XXXXXX - XXXX** and click Start. You’re in.
- 4 Add your first student**
Go to Students → Add. Enter the student’s name, grade, teacher, and MTSS tier. You can bulk import your full caseload later from a CSV file.
- 5 Log your first session**
From the Dashboard, click Quick Log. Pick your student, choose a domain (guidance, planning, responsive services, system support, or non-counseling), add a brief note, and save. This entry feeds your SB 179 compliance meter.
- 6 Check your Dashboard**
Your SB 179 80/20 meter now reflects your first session. As you log more sessions across the week, the meter recalculates in real time. The default alert threshold is 80%.

You’re ready. Log sessions as your day happens — individual, group, hallway conversations, parent calls — and Beacon builds your compliance record for you.

What to explore next

You don't need to learn everything today. Here's what's worth knowing about, in the order most counselors find useful.

Calendar import. Settings → Calendar Import. Upload an .ics export from Google Calendar or Outlook and Beacon classifies your existing calendar events into the correct SB 179 domain by keyword. This is the single biggest time-saver in the app — if you already live in your calendar, you can backfill weeks of compliance data in minutes.

Groups. Create a group, add students, log group sessions with per-student attendance and progress ratings. Five Group Starter Kits are built in: anxiety, friendship, grief, behavior, and social skills. Each comes with an auto-generated lesson plan.

Lessons Library. 35 bundled lessons across academic, social-emotional, and career domains, K–5. Each lesson has objectives, materials, minute-by-minute activities, and assessment notes. Attach a lesson to a session log to document exactly what you delivered.

Communication Templates. 14 parent and family scenarios, each available in English and Spanish (28 total). Parent notifications, progress updates, crisis follow-up, MTSS tier changes, end-of-year summaries. Edit, copy to clipboard, send from your email.

Reports and PDF export. Tier distribution, sessions over time, domain breakdown, referral pipeline, group utilization, compliance percentage. Export any report as PDF to share with your principal as SB 179 proof of compliance.

Backup. Settings → Backup. Download your entire Beacon database as a JSON file. Do this monthly. If you change computers, change districts, or ever need to restore, this file is your insurance policy.

School Year Transition. At the end of the year, Settings → School Year Transition promotes your caseload (K→1, 1→2, and so on) and archives old groups in one action.

What Beacon doesn't do (yet)

We'd rather tell you upfront than have you hunting for features that aren't built. Here's what Beacon is not, as of today.

No cloud sync across counselors. Beacon is local-first by design. Your data lives on your computer. If your district has multiple counselors who want to share a caseload view, that's not built yet.

No email sending from the app. Communication templates are copy-to-clipboard. You paste them into Gmail or Outlook and send from there. Automated email delivery is not built.

No Google Forms live sync. You can import referrals from a CSV file, and you can use the public-facing referral form if it's enabled on your install. Direct Google Forms live sync is not built.

No mobile-native app. Beacon is a Progressive Web App. It installs on iOS and Android home screens and runs like a native app — but it's not in the App Store or Play Store.

License lifecycle

Your license is active for the term you purchased. Beacon checks your license online every five minutes when you have internet, with a 7-day offline grace period.

If your license expires, you can still view and edit your existing records — you just can't create new entries until you renew. To renew, send another Zelle payment to Clear Path and your expiration date will be updated. You keep the same license key.

Need help?

Reply to your welcome email. A real person reads every message.

Clear Path Education Group
clearpathedgroup.com